RACESIMEDIT

Travel Radio Australia. We are in Khan at the Mapik conference here and this conference is all about tourism experiences and people who build things for tourists all around the world and I am very happy to have caught up with IP2 operations holdings from Amsterdam. We have Nick Van Toel and we have Xavier Hoban.

Guys, welcome to the program. Yeah, thank you. Thank you for coming here.

Thanks very much. Pleasure to meet you as well. Now you have a great display here.

You build these fantastic Formula One machines that have screens in front of them and it really feels like you're really driving a Formula One car. Tell us all about it. Yeah, we as Reverrocks, we build these racing simulators, high-end racing simulators.

We have a family with, it's already 30-35 years in the racing industry and from the specialism of building bodyworks for the racing industry we got into the idea of making a high-end simulator and from that idea we went into the leisure market and yeah at the moment we are building complete racing experiences for the entertainment market. It's extremely realistic. I was just watching someone racing and you have a sort of a wraparound screens that really makes you feel that you're in the car and I suppose it has vibrations and all that sort of thing.

Tell us about it, Xavier. Yes, so actually just to kind of give a bit of context as well. So Nick was our partner from Reverrocks and also when I could call him a friend.

We work together on this racing concept and IP2 expertise lies in taking IPs and really kind of translating them into a unique immersive experiences. So we've done it in the past with brands like Dreamworks, Mattel, National Geographic to kind of tap into the kind of the travel scene but with Reverrocks here we're really trying to create a unique experience whereby we take that premium authentic racing feel and combine it with a hospitality offering to really create a location where people can socialize, dwell around F1, around the racing space. So we're launching our concept urban racing club here at Mapik.

It's a smaller 250 square meter footprint. We're looking to be located in high street locations to really create a kind of a hub for youngsters to come together as well as corporates to socialize around an activity. In this case it's racing and Reverrocks have by far the best sims out there in the market so that's why we've teamed up here and we're very excited to launch this concept together.

Yes it's extremely realistic. The graphics you have are just out of this world Nick. Yes we spend a lot of time on that of course.

When you are inside the racing simulator really needs to feel like you're in a real car. So it means

the graphic needs to be super realistic but also the emotion we spend a lot of time on programming and install emotion that it really feels like a real car. We know a lot of people who are in the racing industry so we ask them for all the feedback.

So just jump inside let us know what is feeling well and what is not feeling well and that's how we got into a project that we we built a simulator that needs to be exactly the same as it as how it feels in a real in a real racing car. And your distribution in Europe I mean you're based in Amsterdam and you must have these simulators all around the place tell us about your distribution and where you're going to. We started in the Netherlands we started with some racing centers and then we started to expand to Belgium and we are in the UK in Norway in Switzerland so all the surrounding countries from the Netherlands and yeah and now we're heading to we're also talking to some parties in Australia as well so yeah we want to be worldwide.

As you say you're creating like a social club environment as well as just not not only the the ride itself but the social part is very good. I think that's a very big element so what we've seen is I think the experience economy really taps into this so it sits within a segment called competitive socializing which originates from the UK combining an activity with FMV and this is really what the younger generations want they drink less they want to socialize around an activity it also works very well with corporates who are looking for other ways to do team building events and then within that space racing is really the place to be because the sport has seen tremendous growth in its fan base. I know Australia is very keen on racing of course with with the Grand Prix there but also with things like drive to survive you've seen a lot of diversification a lot of young women are actually coming to the sport and are appealed you know attracted by the whole lifestyle of surrounding the sport and that's what we're trying to tap into with our kind of look and feel around the concept as well it's not just pure only for the die-hard racing fans it's also space where people can connect to the lifestyle more broadly but that is that is racing and do you have other things on the horizon that you're looking at in the future yeah lots and lots of things yeah I'm just thinking about things yeah yeah we try to make the the whole racing experience even more holistic we already add a light show to it as smoke wind even sense how we program everything on the game but we are making it like a whole storyline from beginning to the end from the booking until you leave the premises you need to be in a storyline and yeah that's what we work on to make it even more impressive and more entertaining I'm watching your video here I can see when you build these experiences the machines it's like sort of like building a Formula One car itself it's pretty pretty much the same thing yeah it is yeah you know when it comes to the technique you know you're always improving yeah you know the time comes with new developments as well on the hardware so we try to implement all the new techniques that are on the market yeah so we never we never stop developing that's for sure and how can people find out more online about the products and and and how how can see people see more yes so I think of course refrox has their own website where you can see the latest installations they've done to really get a feel of the experience and also the IP2 group we have our own website which is www.ip2group.com and maybe this could be relevant for the the listen of the travel radio at IP2

group we also have some cultural projects so actually later this month we've got a venue opening near Pompeii which is called legacy life in partnership with Discovery Channel which basically brings a bit of legacy back alive through an immersive walk through experience and we're looking to replicate us around the world so maybe Australia's up next so on that the people can sort of imagine that they're in the Pompeii just before the before the eruption right yeah so correct the thinking around this concept is it's supposed to be complementary to the ancient sites so people go to the ancient site and often the question they arrive with and they often leave with which is unanswered is what did it look like at the time the legacy life concept is trying to exactly answer that question so it's often in proximity to the ancient site so it's a combined visit people often go either first to legacy life or to the cultural side or vice versa and it brings the experience back alive through media thematic walkthroughs for instance if there's one room where you can interact with the different types of gladiators an interactive screen you can select and then it's as if you're the gladiator so it brings that kind of ancient Roman life back alive and we're trying to replicate this around the world so we're looking at places like Peru which has a very rich history on Machu Picchu Athens of course with the Acropolis and we'll see the many legacies to be told in Australia as well yes it would work great at places like Uluru with you know the the Aboriginal background and all that kind of stuff would be fantastic to show people what it was really like back then within cultural tourism we're also seeing this similar shift people no longer just want to look at something they want to be able to experience it so even within museums or cultural tourism we're seeing this real push towards immersive experiences now I think a lot of it has been VR driven temporary pop-up installations which don't always reach the right quality level with what we're envisioning is really a full development permit location that you know is there to stay and often that's why we we've partnered up with Discovery Channel you get the authenticity you get the you know we involve local historians to really tell the accurate story but yeah this is something that we're looking to expand further and who knows you know in 10 or 15 years the way AI and holographic technology is going you can in 10 or 15 years you might be even be able to immerse yourself completely in something hundreds and hundreds of years ago oh yeah for sure you know we're already using AI in all different sort of ways also when it comes to for example training the driver who is inside the simulator you can already use AI for that so now it's just the beginning and I think there will be a lot of new things to come for sure guys thank you so much for being with us on Travel Radio Australia it's a fascinating area and congratulations on what you've achieved so far thanks thanks for coming thank you very much